

GREAT SKY AI

# Website Handoff Guide

Everything you need to deploy the Great Sky AI website under your own accounts and connect your domain.

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PREPARED BY

Lightsmith Design

VERSION

1.0

PREVIEW

[great-sky-ai.vercel.app](https://great-sky-ai.vercel.app)

## SECTION 01

# What you are receiving

The Great Sky AI website is a **static site** - plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript. There is no database, no server-side code and no build step. This makes it fast, inexpensive to host, and simple to maintain.

| Item         | Details                                                                                            |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Preview URL  | great-sky-ai.vercel.app                                                                            |
| Source code  | A complete copy of the website files, ready to upload to your own GitHub account                   |
| Technology   | Static HTML5, CSS3, vanilla JavaScript. No frameworks, no build step.                              |
| Pages        | Home, Tech, About, Careers, News, Contact, Privacy, Terms, plus 6 news articles and 4 job listings |
| Fonts        | STIX Two Text, Inter, Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono (loaded free via Google Fonts)                    |
| Hosting cost | Free tier available; Vercel Pro (~\$20/month) is the correct plan for commercial use               |

**Read this first**

The site is complete and the contact forms are live. **One item remains before public launch** (Section 02): search engines are currently blocked from indexing the site, which is deliberate while it sits on a temporary preview address.

## SECTION 02

# Before you go live

The site is complete and the contact forms are connected. One switch remains to be flipped at launch.

**Search engines are currently blocked**

The site sends a `noindex` instruction on every page, telling Google not to list it. This is correct while the site lives on a temporary preview URL - it stops the preview from competing with your real domain in search results.

**To fix at launch:** open `vercel.json`, delete the `X-Robots-Tag` line below, and redeploy.

```
{ "key": "X-Robots-Tag", "value": "noindex" }, <-- DELETE THIS LINE
```

**Timing matters**

Do not remove the `noindex` until **after** your real domain is connected and working. Removing it early lets Google index the temporary `.vercel.app` address, which can then compete with your real domain.

## How your forms work

The contact form and the newsletter signup are both connected to **Formspree**, a form-handling service. When someone submits either form, the submission is delivered to you by email - there is no database to manage and nothing to maintain.

| Detail                 | Where to find it                                                                                 |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Where submissions go   | Your Formspree dashboard at <a href="https://formspree.io">formspree.io</a> , and by email       |
| Changing the recipient | In Formspree, open the form and edit its notification email address                              |
| Spam protection        | A hidden honeypot field silently discards bot submissions                                        |
| Free tier              | Formspree's free plan covers 50 submissions per month; paid plans are available if you need more |

### Worth testing first

Before you announce the site, send yourself a test message through the contact form and confirm it arrives. This is on the launch checklist in Section 07.

## SECTION 03

# Getting the site running

Follow these in order. No coding experience is required. Budget roughly 30-45 minutes, plus time for DNS to update.

### Step 1 - Create a GitHub account

GitHub stores the website's code and its history. Go to [github.com](https://github.com) and sign up. A free account is sufficient. Use a company email address rather than a personal one, so the account can outlive any single employee.

### Step 2 - Create your copy of the code

You will receive the website files as a folder. To put them into your own GitHub account:

- 1 In GitHub, click **New repository**. Name it, for example *great-sky-website*.
- 2 Set it to **Private** unless you want the code publicly visible.
- 3 Leave README, .gitignore and license unchecked.
- 4 Click **Create repository**, then choose **uploading an existing file** and drag in the contents of the *great-sky-site* folder.
- 5 Click **Commit changes**.

### Step 3 - Create your own Formspree account

Your contact form and newsletter signup submit through Formspree, a form-delivery service. It is already wired into the site's code - but it currently points at a Formspree account controlled by your developer. **Before launch, create your own Formspree account and reconnect the forms to it.**

This matters because submissions are your business data - the leads and inquiries this site exists to generate. If they continue flowing into someone else's account, you are permanently dependent on that person for access, and if that account is ever cancelled, your forms stop working with no warning to you.

- 1 Go to **formspree.io** and create a free account.
- 2 Create two forms: one for the contact page, one for the newsletter signup.
- 3 Copy each form's ID - the last part of the web address it gives you, for example the `xnqkldwr` in `formspree.io/f/xnqkldwr`.
- 4 In the website code, open `script.js` and find the FORMSPREE section near the top. Replace the two placeholder IDs with your own, then commit the change.

#### Test it

Send yourself a message through the contact form and confirm it arrives before you announce the site is live. This is also on the checklist in Section 07.

### Step 4 - Create a Vercel account

Vercel is the hosting platform. Go to **vercel.com** and choose **Continue with GitHub** - signing in this way links the two accounts automatically, which makes the next step trivial.

#### A note on plans

Vercel's free Hobby plan prohibits commercial use in its terms. For a company website the **Pro plan (around \$20/month)** is the compliant choice. This site is small enough that you will not approach any usage limits.

### Step 5 - Deploy

- 1 In the Vercel dashboard click **Add New, Project**.
- 2 Find your repository and click **Import**.
- 3 Leave every build setting at its default. There is no build command and no framework - if asked for a Framework Preset, choose **Other**.
- 4 If your repository contains a `great-sky-site` folder rather than the files directly, set **Root Directory** to `great-sky-site`.
- 5 Click **Deploy** and wait about a minute.

You will be given a temporary address ending in `.vercel.app`. Open it and confirm the site loads correctly before continuing to the domain setup.

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## SECTION 04

# Connecting your domain

This points your real web address (for example *greatsky.ai*) at the site you just deployed. You will need access to wherever the domain was purchased - the **registrar** (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare and so on).

### Step 1 - Add the domain in Vercel

- 1 Open your project in Vercel, then **Settings, Domains**.

- 2 Type your domain (for example `greatsky.ai`) and click **Add**.
- 3 Vercel will display the exact DNS records to create. **Use the values Vercel shows you** - they are specific to your project and can change over time.

## Step 2 - Add those records at your registrar

Log in to your registrar, find the DNS settings for the domain, and add the records Vercel gave you. They will look something like this:

| Type  | Name / Host | Value                            |
|-------|-------------|----------------------------------|
| A     | @           | (the IP address Vercel displays) |
| CNAME | www         | cname.vercel-dns.com             |

The @ symbol means the domain itself (*greatsky.ai*); *www* covers *www.greatsky.ai*. Adding both means the site works either way.

## Step 3 - Wait, then verify

DNS changes usually take 10 to 60 minutes, occasionally up to 48 hours. Vercel's Domains screen shows a live status and displays a valid checkmark once everything resolves. HTTPS (the padlock) is issued automatically and free - you do not need to buy an SSL certificate.

## Step 4 - Turn on search engine indexing

Now that the real domain works, complete item 2 from Section 02: remove the X-Robots-Tag line from `vercel.json` and redeploy. Then submit the domain to **Google Search Console** so Google begins indexing it.

## SECTION 05

# Editing the site going forward

Because the site is plain HTML, edits can be made directly in GitHub's web editor without installing anything. **Every time you save a change, Vercel automatically redeploys the site within about a minute.**

## Where things live

| File or folder                                             | What it controls                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <code>index.html</code>                                    | Home page                                    |
| <code>tech / about / careers / news / contact .html</code> | The main interior pages                      |
| <code>privacy.html, terms.html</code>                      | Legal pages                                  |
| <code>news/</code>                                         | Individual news articles, one HTML file each |
| <code>careers/</code>                                      | Individual job listings, one HTML file each  |

| File or folder | What it controls                                                       |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| styles.css     | All visual styling, colours and typography                             |
| script.js      | Interactions: menu, scroll effects, form handling                      |
| assets/        | All images, logos and photography                                      |
| vercel.json    | Hosting configuration (clean URLs, caching, security headers, noindex) |

## Making a simple text edit

- 1 In GitHub, open the file you want to change.
- 2 Click the pencil icon (Edit this file).
- 3 Find the text and change it. Leave anything inside angle brackets alone.
- 4 Scroll down and click **Commit changes**.
- 5 Wait about a minute, then refresh the live site.

## Adding a news article or job listing

Duplicate an existing file in `news/` or `careers/`, rename it, edit its contents, then add a link to it on the matching index page (`news.html` or `careers.html`). Matching the structure of the existing files keeps the styling consistent automatically.

### If something breaks

Every change is versioned. In GitHub open the **Commits** history, find the last good version and revert to it - the site rolls back automatically. Nothing is ever permanently lost.

## SECTION 06

# Security and code review

A full review of the codebase was completed before handoff. Results below.

## Passed

| Check                  | Result                                                                          |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Secrets in source code | None. No API keys, passwords or tokens are present.                             |
| External link safety   | All 88 external links use <code>rel=noopener</code> , preventing tab-hijacking. |
| Broken links           | None. All internal links and image references resolve.                          |
| Image accessibility    | All 92 images have descriptive alt text.                                        |
| Contact forms          | Connected to Formspree and delivering. Honeypot spam protection in place.       |

| Check                 | Result                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| JavaScript quality    | Strict mode, no eval, no unsafe HTML injection, respects reduced-motion.                                              |
| Leftover placeholders | None. No TODO or template text remains.                                                                               |
| HTTPS                 | Enforced automatically, including HSTS.                                                                               |
| Security headers      | Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options, Referrer-Policy and Permissions-Policy are all set. |
| Page weight           | Images optimised at handoff: total site size reduced from 19 MB to under 7 MB.                                        |

## Remaining recommendations

Neither is urgent, and neither blocks launch.

| Item                | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Adding new services | The Content-Security-Policy in vercel.json lists which outside services the site may talk to (currently Google Fonts and Formspree). If you later add analytics or another tool, its domain must be added there or the browser will block it. |
| Lazy loading        | 20 of 92 images currently load lazily. Extending this to more below-the-fold images would further improve load speed on slower connections.                                                                                                   |

## SECTION 07

# Launch checklist

Work top to bottom. The site is fully live once every box is ticked.

| Task                                                                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Create a GitHub account                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Upload the website files to a new repository               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Create your own Formspree account and reconnect both forms |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Create a Vercel account (Pro plan for commercial use)      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Import the repository and deploy                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm the temporary .vercel.app URL loads correctly      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Add your domain in Vercel and copy the DNS records         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Add the DNS records at your registrar                      |

### Task

- ☐ Wait for DNS to resolve and confirm the HTTPS padlock appears
- ☐ Remove the noindex line from vercel.json and redeploy
- ☐ Submit the domain to Google Search Console
- ☐ Optional: extend lazy loading to more images

### Questions

For anything unclear in this document, or for help connecting the contact form, contact Lightsmith Design.